Befitting a Prince

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/48196558.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Teela (He-Man), He-Man | Adam, Glimmer (She-Ra)

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by ResFlower

Summary

Catra let out a laugh, her hand dropping to her torso. Her belly was flat, yet something in her bones told her she was not mistaken—she was with child, a perfect combination of her and Adora. She and Adora had been through so much in recent years, they deserved to have a light like this, especially now that the war was over.

Catra's smile dropped from her face. "Oh no." For a moment, she'd forgotten that she and Adora weren't married. Or rather, the implication for any children they might have out of wedlock.

The child she was carrying wouldn't be king. No child could be King of Halfmoon if born out of wedlock. She'd been married to Adora, and if it hadn't been because she was declared dead, they would still be married now. Adora and Catra had pledged themselves to each other in all the ways that mattered.

And yet, Adora still hadn't proposed. As much as she knew that Adora was committed to Catra, body and soul, she was weary of forcing the topic of marriage. Catra committed to giving Adora this choice, and she still had not chosen to wed again.

OR

Adora is gaining the courage to propose and Catra needs to tell her that they're expecting. Medieval AU. Can be read without the main fic!

Notes

You do not need to read the main fic although, I think it would add detail and context to this one.

Useful facts for folks who have not read the main fic:
-Adora disappeared and was presumed dead for 3 years after she and Catra married.
-The Horde was taking over Etheria and the kingdoms pulled together to form an alliance to combat t, which Catra ultimately was in charge of.
-Adora got her She-ra powers during her disappearance and used them to fight in the war. Before she married Catra she was Princess Glimmer's personal guard.
-Because Adora was declared dead during her disappearance, their marriage was dissolved.

Ok, everything else I think is self-explanatory. Please enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra had avoided the beginning of the festivities, opting to arrive late. She couldn't believe the news and it's already been a full week of letting it sink in. Lord Hordak had been captured and the Horde was done for, a majority of their soldiers scattering and abandoning their posts once the news spread. It felt like all of Halfmoon had been a loud celebration from the moment it found out, Catra making the announcement on her balcony, overlooking the waiting crowds.

Now, she made her way down to the main dining hall—it was an odd feeling, to know that the same scene playing out in Halfmoon was happening in every kingdom today. Across all of Etheria, there seemed to only be room for joy. The room teemed with life, raucous noise pouring out of the door as Catra entered the room.

Almost immediately she caught a familiar stare. "Catra," Adora called loudly, cupping her mouth to make her voice carry over the masses. The blonde grinned at her broadly, eyes bright blue as they locked into her.

Adora all but ran toward her, wrapping her arms around Catra and pulling her into a tight hug. Around them, the soldiers and civilians alike cheer. Some of them chanted for a kiss, having been used to how amorous the couple was when they'd reigned together. Adora pulled back but still held her hand, her cheeks reddened under the scrutiny.

Catra grinned at the warrior. "I don't mind if you don't," Catra whispered, leaning closer to Adora.

Adora shook her head gently. "I don't think our first public kiss should be here." Still, she bit her lip as if tempted.

"It wouldn't be our first public kiss." Catra reminded. They'd kissed plenty of times in public before Adora's disappearance a year and a half ago.

"We're unmarried, Catra." There was almost a rumble in her chest, her eyes darker as she let her eyes rove Catra.

Catra felt a twinge at the reminder but she brushed it aside. She thought about saying a joke—maybe telling Adora that she didn't seem to mind that they were unmarried when she snuck into Catra's room the night before—but instead, her arms shot out to grab Adora, a bout of dizziness overcoming her.

"Catra? Are you alright?" Adora pulled her gently into a deserted hallway, one hand coming up to her face. "Love?" She prompted.

Catra took a deep breath through her nose keeping a tight grip on Adora as the world slowly righted itself. When she opened her eyes again, it was to the blonde eyeing her with concern.

"I'm better " Catra assured, her voice sounding weak even to her own ears.

"What happened?" She asked.

"Dizzy." Catra offered curtly, still staving off the effects. It took her another few minutes before she truly felt herself again. "I think all the emotions might be getting to me." It had been a long few months leading up to the defeat of the Horde, with late nights in strategy meetings and Adora away to fight in battles as She-ra for weeks at a time. Catra kissed the furrow on Adora's brow. "I'll be alright. I'm going to go to bed and you can stay here." It was late anyway and Catra had been more tired lately. An effect of the stress, no doubt.

"I can go with you," Adora said, clearly still concerned. She was holding Catra in such a familiar way, anyone who walked by would know that they were lovers. Catra didn't think anyone was duped by their propriety anyway, but it seemed to matter to Adora.

"You can't." Catra reminded her. As much as the idea was laughable, that they were doing anything but cavorting together, Adora had her separate room and duties since they remained unmarried. "You're She-ra. Celebrate this win. It's good for morale." She encouraged. No one fought harder than Adora to

bring peace to Etheria. She'd be damned if the blonde didn't get to celebrate in the spoils.

Adora looked around for a moment before pressing a sweet kiss to Catra's lips. "If you're sure. I'll be up in an hour to keep you warm." She promised lowly.

Catra let herself rest in Adora's arms for a moment before pulling back. "Then, I'll be waiting. If I need you, I'll send for you."

A cloud of worry still marred Adora's beautiful face but she nodded, letting Catra go. "Okay, love. Sleep well." She placed a tender kiss on Catra's forehead.

She gave Adora a smile nodding for her to go ahead without her. Catra was looking forward to tonight—it would be the third night in a row that Adora had stayed in her room, holding closely throughout the night.

Catra stopped twice more as she walked toward her room, having to hold onto the wall as she felt the room spin. It catches her off guard, each time coming on suddenly and then leaving slowly. She breathed a sigh of relief once she got to her bedroom. Catra removed her clothing, slipping into her bed. The world seemed to stop turning on its head for a moment and the cool sheets served to ground her. Maybe the dizziness was borne of her cycle—sometimes it made her lightheaded.

She froze as she pondered the thought. Catra realized she was supposed to bleed weeks ago. As they closed in on the Horde, she had little time to care about anything, least of all this. She tried to think back to the last time that she bled and she had to reach too far in her memory for it.

Catra let out a laugh, her hand dropping to her torso. Her belly was flat, yet something in her bones told her she was not mistaken—she was with child, a perfect combination of her and Adora. This wasn't in the plans at all but she couldn't say it upset her. She needed an heir, but more than that she wanted this baby.

She and Adora had been through so much in recent years, they deserved to have a light like this, especially now that the war was over.

Catra's smile dropped from her face. "Oh no." For a moment, she'd forgotten that she and Adora weren't married. Or rather, the implication for any children they might have out of wedlock.

The child she was carrying wouldn't be king. No child could be King of Halfmoon if born out of wedlock. Catra shook her head an exasperated sigh overcoming her—it was so stupid. She'd been married to Adora, and if it hadn't been because she was declared dead, they would still be married now. It was meant to be ceremonial. Adora and Catra had pledged themselves to each other in all the ways that mattered.

And yet, Adora still hadn't proposed. As much as she knew that Adora was committed to Catra body and soul, she was weary of forcing the topic of marriage. Catra committed to giving Adora this choice, and she still had not chosen to wed again.

Catra took a deep breath, attempting to settle her nerves. Adora said she'd ask when the war was over. And now it was. In the best possible world, she could give Adora some time and hopefully, the blonde would propose before the week was out and Catra could give them the news. That they were not only meant to be wives again but also mothers.

Catra would just have to hold this secret for a little while.

Adora typically loved visiting Bright Moon—and her dear friends, Glimmer and Bow—but she was so tired of traveling. Adora thought winning the war would be different. She thought once the Horde was defeated she'd be done with her duties and would be able to return to her life. The one she was ripped from when SHe-ra's sword chose her. Her life in Halfmoon.

And yet, there was still so much to do. It was as if peace somehow brought more tasks with it, not less. She needed to coordinate relief efforts, follow up on threats on security, tie up loose ends. All of it pulled her from Halfmoon, where she wanted to be.

"Adora!" Glimmer greeted her warmly, a big smile and a spring in her step. The end of the war made everyone happy, but Glimmer was damn near euphoric. "The tea is ready." She beckoned Adora closer, gesturing for her to sit.

Adora did so, a grin in her lips. "Where is Bow?" She looked around for some clue that her friend would be joining but there were only two tea cups out.

Glimmer rolled her eyes. "He's meeting us for dinner. You'll have to deal with me until then, I'm afraid." She hid her smile behind her tea.

"That's no trouble for me." Even though it had been years, Adora looked back at her time as a Bright Moon guard fondly because she spent the time with Glimmer. She had no closer or better friend, except perhaps her brother.

"Well, it might be when I'm done harassing you." She put down her tea cup and gave Adora a level stare. "When will you make an honest woman of your wife?" Glimmer asked impatiently, her arms crossed against her chest.

"Ah, splendid topic of conversation." Adora muttered as she picked up a sugar cube and plopped it into her drink.

Glimmer ignored her snide remark. "It's been a year since Bow and I married. I'm just itching to plan a royal wedding." She wagged her finger. "And the war is done! Peace is restored! So, how many days do I have before I start planning?" She was practically bouncing in her chair at the excitement.

"I—I'm not sure." Adora stuttered. She should have realized that Glimmer would ask these types of questions but she'd simply not

thought of it. "There's still so much to wind down. I need to make sure all these things happen. It's like somehow I'm more involved now that we've won." She complained.

"Thay doesn't mean you can't have a life, Adora! When will you stop sacrificing yourself for the greater good? It almost tore you're relationship apart once before." Glimmer warned. It wasn't the first time they'd had this conversation, but it was the first time since the end of the war.

"I know! And I'll ask. I'm planning on asking soon! I already waited for the end of the war I don't have a lot more patience." She sighed running a hand through her short hair. "At this point, I'd just like an opening where I'm in Halfmoon for more than a week at a time." She grumbled balefully. It wasn't easy, being away from home so often.

A flicker of guilt crossed Glimmer's face. "I'm sorry. I asked you to come out here to help with loose ends, just like everyone else."

Adora waved her off. "Nonsense. It's necessary." She gave Glimmer a tired smile. "That's part of what makes it difficult—I know most of the requests are being made because I can make an impact." Individually, it was hard to justify saying no. But in the aggregate, it made for an impossible schedule that she couldn't keep up with. Adora had thrown herself into the past-war efforts, hopeful she'd make enough of a dent she wouldn't have to travel at all, but it seemed that was an ambitious notion.

"Still. Don't you worry about what Catra might think? Didn't you promise to propose after Bow and I wed?" Glimmer asked, her hand reaching out and landing on Adora's shoulder. "I'm worried about you two."

Her eyes snapped up to the shorter woman. "Did Catra say anything to you?"

"No. But I'd be a fool if I didn't know she wanted to marry you. And that you wanted to marry her."

Adora let out a deep sigh. "I know I've taken rather long. I want—we've been through so much, Glimmer. I want to propose to Catra and have it be everything she's ever dreamed. She asked me the first time we got married and I remember it so fondly. I want that same for her."

Every idea that Adora had didn't feel like enough. Catra deserved the world and Adora wanted to give it to her. She'd told Catra she'd propose after Glimmer and Bow got married but then the fighting got worse and she'd promised she would do it after the war was over. But now, it'd been three weeks and she'd only been in Halfmoon for a handful of days. Nevermind finding time to plan a proposal.

"Adora." Glimmer sighed, giving her a pitying look. "Catra would marry you regardless of how you ask. Don't let that stop you." She encouraged.

Adora ran a hand along her hair, almost spilling her tea. "It's easy to say but it's been so long and we've been through so much." She bit her lip. "How is Catra ever supposed to forgive me for disappearing? She thought I was dead, Glimmer."

Glimmer's eyes widen on Adora. "That wasn't your fault. Do you blame Catra for being kidnapped by the Horde?" She asked testily.

Adora rolled her eyes. Catra had been kidnapped for a few short days. Adora had disappeared for three years. It was hardly a comparison point. "Of course not."

She narrowed her gaze. "Then, you know what I'm going to say."

"You're right." She shook her head. "I'm going to ask her soon. The moment I get a chance to be in Halfmoon for more than two days at a time." Adora wanted to marry Catra again, to make sure nothing would stand between them.

Glimmer nodded. "See that you do." Her serious face melted into a warn smile. "I'm so happy for you."

Adora smiled brightly, feeling a little giddy at the prospect. She'd ask Catra to marry and they'd get a chance to start over and heal.

Catra's bed felt particularly cold tonight. She turned over, looking at the empty expanses beside her with a heavy sigh. Adora was on another diplomatic mission, trying to reign in the last hold outs of the Horde. The Alliance hadn't disbanded, but with their primary purpose gone, a lot of the post war efforts were more decentralized. Which meant everyone was calling on Adora to fix their problems.

And *that* meant that Catra was lying in bed alone, rubbing the place where she was sure life was growing. She felt a sense of wonder as she thought about the fact that their kit was growing. She also felt a tug of guilt at the fact that she hadn't told Adora.

She knew she had to talk with Adora and she wanted to, but it felt like everytime she arrived at Halfmoon, the blonde was exhausted. She always greeted Catra with a sweet kiss, a promise that she'd rushed as fast as she could to be back in Halfmoon, and a hug that felt like it righted anything that could be wrong. When faced with everything she always wanted—Adora, attentive and affectionate, asking her about her day—it was hard to break the news.

It was a hard thing to say. She couldn't just blurt out that there would be three of them now. And that wouldn't even address the question of whether they should get married to preserve their child's claim to the throne.

A part of her, deep down—the part that thought Adora was dead for years, that felt betrayed when she realized her wife was alive and captured—wondered if Adora no longer wanted to marry. It'd been a month and a half since the Alliance claimed victory. She knew Adora had been busy—she'd been busy too between the effects of her pregnancy and transitioning Halfmoon out of its wartime economy—but it was just one question between them.

How hard could it be, for Adora to ask her if she truly wanted to remarry as she promised?

Catra sighed, slipping out of her bed. Sleep was useless when she felt like this. She aimlessly walked the halls, ignoring the curious eyes of her guards as she made her way to he study. Maybe she'd get some work done and that would lead to sleep. Before she reached her office, she saw that Tao's study was lit up. As she flicked her ear, she could pick up the occasional flip of a page. She walked toward her advisor's door, rapping her knuckles on it before opening the door.

"Burning the late night oil tonight?"

He looked up from his papers, his ears up and alert for a moment before he smiled. "I could say the same to you, your majesty."

"I suppose so." It's not the first time they've found each other late at night. Tao was her most loyal confidante, more father than advisor at this point in her life. Her worried bubbled up as she looked at him. "Tao...say I have a purely hypothetical question." She started out hesitantly.

He snorted, raising a gray eyebrow. "Is there ever such a thing?" He asked with a heavy look.

Catra was well and caught but she pretended she wasn't. "Today, there is." She even gave him a cheeky grin. "As King, I decree it."

Tao rolled his eyes, his tail waving in amusement. "Then ask away, your majesty."

She sat across from him, clapsing her hands together on his desk. "If a royal were to fall pregnant out of wedlock...how would title pass?"

His eyes widened in surprise, eyes dipping down to where Catra was clutching her torso before flying up to her face. "You know as well as I do that it wouldn't." Tao said slowly, his eyes roaming

Catra's face with his unspoken question. "For title to pass, the royal would have to wed."

"And if the couple were to marry during the pregnancy?" Catra pressed. It was a question that she'd been meaning to address with Tao anyway. She thought she knew the answer but she wanted to be sure.

"In truth, the law only calls for them to be married by the birth of the kit. Although, it would be unseemly to wait until after the pregnancy announcement." Tao gave her a knowing look. "Anything to tell me, your majesty?" He needled.

Catra shook her head, ears pinned back. "No. Nothing at all."

He looked at her like he didn't believe her, incredulous as always. "Well. If—hypothetically—there were an heir of Halfmoon...that would make me incredibly happy."

The statement filled her with warmth. "Thank you, Tao. I'll let alert you when there's something to know."

He looked amused. "When. Not if." He noted. Tao gave her a tender smile and closed his book. "Goodnight, your majesty. Sleep is important." He was almost stern in how he narrowed his gaze but his smile was so wide it missed the mark.

She sighed, and raised a hand in surrender. Catra supposed that most of her things could wait until tomorrow. "I'll try to go back to sleep."

"See that you do. And if you need anything at all, you let me know." His voice was almost gruff with emotion.

Catra nodded. "I will. Thank you, Tao. For everything."

She made her way back down the hallway. Although she didn't resolve anything, seeing Tao eased her some. His presence had always been a stabilizing force, not only for her reign, but for her personal life.

As she turned the corner, her mouth filled with saliva and an unpleasant sensation rolled through her gut. Panicked, she turned to the closest receptacle—a planter a few feet away—and emptied the contents of her stomach. With the nausea came the dizziness and Catra cursed herself for being so weak. She wished that Adora was there. Catra knew that the blonde would hold Catra in her arms and make her feel better, just by being there.

"Catra?" She whipped her head around at the sleepy mumble and the sudden movement made her retch into the planter again. "Catra!" Adam approached her quickly, one of his strong hands rubbing along her back as she breathes in. "What do I do?" He sounded absolutely panicked.

Catra took a deep breath through her nose, the nausea subsiding some. "Water." She croaked out.

Adam nodded frantically. "I can do that!"

He all but sprinted away back toward his room. He came back so quickly Catra's hands were still trembling when she wrapped them around the cup, rinsing out her mouth and spitting it out.

She winced at the planter. "We're going to have to deal with that tomorrow." She mumbled. How embarrassing, to be caught this way by Adam. Although she was close to her brother-in-law, he wasn't the first person he'd ask for help in this kind of situation.

Still, he collected himself and gave her a reassuring smile. "I'll let one of the guards know. They'll find someone to take care of it."

Catra felt embarrassment burn through her. "What a mess." She grumbled.

"The better question is, what are you doing up at this hour?" Adam asked, crossing his arms across his chest. "Did you eat something? Are you sick?" He reached up to put his hand on her forehead as if checking for fever. Catra growled, baring her fangs at him. He pulled his hand back, eyeing her warily.

"I'm fine." She answered reflexively.

"You don't just throw up like that if you're fine, Catra." He said sternly, probably the only person currently in Halfmoon who would speak to the king this way. "And you don't growl a warning for fun either. You're incredibly even-tempered most of the time. What's wrong?"

"It's fine." She repeated through gritted teeth. "I just need to get to my room."

"No! You need a doctor. Adora isn't here to tell you these things so I have to." He replied stubbornly getting in Catra's way.

Catra's tail jerked in agitation. "I could order your execution, you know?"

"You won't." He replied easily, sounding so much like Adora it made her heart clench. "Now, you sit tight I'm going to get the doctor."

"No!" Catra took a deep breath. "I'm pregnant. That's why I was sick."

Adam stared at her with wide blue eyes as he wrapped his head around the new information. "You're pregnant?" He sputtered. "But Catra, how did that even happen?" He blurted out.

She scoffed at the silly question. "I'm not explaining where babies come from, Adam. Read a book. Or ask Teela." She sighed as she thinks of her red-headed advisor. "Nevermind, don't subject her to that. It'll make her question all her life choices." AS much as she loved Adam, she did find it surprising he was able to romance Teela.

His face turned beet red. "You know what I mean!"

Catra raised an eyebrow. "And you know what I do with your sister." She added a leer for good measure. If she couldn't execute him, she'd think of something worse.

He made a face like he might be the one retching soon. "That's unnecessary."

"Don't ask questions you don't want the answers to." Catra sighed. "You can't tell Adora I'm pregnant." She added.

His whole body froze at that and the color he gained from embarrassment quickly faded from his face. "Adora doesn't know?" He looked horrified, eyes rounded and mouth agape. "You mean to tell me that I'm finding out about my sister's child before her?"

"Quiet!" Catra hissed, grabbing his meaty arm and dragging him into her study two doors down. "She doesn't know and you can't tell her." She ordered. Adora could be Adam's sister but she was his King. He was bound to obey.

"Why ever not?" He shook his head, tugging at his hair. "I'm tired of you two keeping monumental secrets from each other and sticking me in the middle." He complained.

"Well, maybe the next time you hear a woman retching you'll leave her alone." Catra snapped back testily.

The air stayed tense but then Adam looked down to her waist. "How far along are you?"

"A few months at most. I haven't seen the doctor yet." She knew she had to but it felt wrong to do it without Adora.

For a split second, Adam looked as if he was about to coo, a dreamy look in his eyes. The look quickly turned beseeching as he clasped his hands together."Catra, I'm begging you. Please, tell Adora. You *know* Adora will be thrilled."

"I don't want to pressure her to get married." Catra said flatly.

Adam tugged at his hair again. "She obviously wants to marry you." He spit out. "And she isn't so arcane to propose out of

duty." He paused for a moment as if thinking about taking that statement back, but ultimately held firm.

"Perhaps that's true, but she wants to do it in her own time." She pointed out. For one reason or another, Adora hasn't asked. It rubs Catra raw at times but it's Adora's decision.

Something in Adam seemed to snap. "Well, she should have thought about that before she created a responsibility that she must own up to!" Adam's face was red as he pointed at Catra's abdomen. It seemed at least one of the siblings knew something about an arcane sense fo duty.

She wrapped her arms protectively around her torso. "Don't talk about my child that way!" Catra's teeth were barred again and genuine fear flickered across Adam's face. She controlled herself, pulling a step back and running a hand over her flat belly. "Sorry. This is exactly what I'd like to avoid." She sighed. Most of the time she felt well in control of herself but at times it felt like she was being pulled in two directions, sadness and anger. "I don't want Adora to marry me out of some sense of responsibility to the kit."

"But Adora wants to marry you independently." Adam pointed out needlessly.

"Then why hasn't she asked me!" The words exploded out of her. She took a deep breath, trying to moderate her voice. "Adora said she would, but it's been weeks since Lord Hordak was defeated." She knows that Adora has been stretched thin for a long time, but how much longer could she possibly need? Catra runs her claws over her belly. "And if we want this child to be the heir of the throne, we don't have much time."

Adam's mouth forms a perfect 'o'. "The kit would be out of wedlock. Not the future king of Halfmoon." He realized before shaking his head. "You need to get married to Adora soon. Like, yesterday if possible."

She sighed angrily as Adam ran face-first into the point. "So, you see how this is a lot of pressure to put on your sister? As she leads the post war efforts and is clearly preoccupied with other things?"

"It's not a crime to want things for yourself, Catra. Or to ask for them." Adam advised, one of his hands coming to rest on Catra's shoulder.

"I want her to want me. It's not something I can ask for." Why was it so hard for everyone to understand? She wanted Adora to be the one to make the decision. The last time, Catra had to pursue Adora. It was the only way a prince like herself could marry a commoner. But now, Adora had a title of her own as the Princess of Power. She could choose whatever her heart desired. Catra needed to know, to have the assurance that Adora chose this life with her.

Adam let out an exasperated sigh. "So then what's the solution? Hope Adora doesn't notice you're with child? That's laughable, your majesty."

"I don't have a plan, Adam! I'm constantly nauseous and tired and cranky and now I have this problem that I don't know how to solve. And I'm going to be a mother." She tacked on, feeling defeated. "I just want my wife." She admitted in a low voice. "I want Adora to make all of this go away."

"Then, tell her that." Adam said before softening. He reached forward, giving Catra a warm hug. "I'm sorry. Truly. I'm happy to help with whatever you need, Catra. But none of this will be better until you talk to her. Trust that she wants to be in this mess with you rather than leave you with it all alone."

Catra sighed. "You may have a point." She admitted. The problems were likely bigger in her head, and heavier on her heart because she didn't speak of them with Adora. "I've also known for a few weeks and she's going to be so angry at me for keeping it

from her." It was a terrifying thought for Adora to hold it against her.

"She won't." He said resolutely. "She'll be too happy that she's going to be having a kit that she's hoping will look just like you."

The mental image made her smile. "I hope you're right, Adam."

"I know my sister. Trust, Catra." He assured as he pulled her into a hug. "Now, let's get you to bed. You need to sleep or Adora will kill me."

"So her death threats are better than mine?" Catra couldn't help but snark as she let her brother-in-law fuss over her.

"Yes. You won't kill me, but she would if anything happened to you on my watch." He said with a broad grin, seemingly unbothered by the thought. "I'm going to be an uncle." He whispered almost to himself.

Catra's ear flicked as she caught his last words. "You are. I'm sure the kit will love you." She could imagine just how much Adam would love their child.

His eyes widened. "Oh, a kit! They're going to have soft little ears! And a tail!"

Catra let out a laugh. "You've seen them before, Adam." She pointed out amusedly.

"It's not the same. It'll be family."

"True." She felt tears well in her eyes from the stupid hormones wracking her body. "I'm going to sleep." She muttered gruffly.

Adam broke protocol again and hugged her fiercely. "Tell Adora so we can all celebrate. I'm so happy for both of you."

"I will." She was never going to keep it a secret forever. Catra just needed to find a way to say something the next time she saw

Adora, regardless of how long the blonde could stay in Halfmoon.

Adora wasn't supposed to be in Halfmoon for another day and a half but she convinced Mermista to let her beg off before she was scheduled to leave. The trip from Salineas felt longer than usual but the relief she felt when she snuck in through Catra's window made it worth it.

She breathed out a small sigh as she saw her love curled up, a soft purr rumbling through her chest as she slept. Adora's heart no longer fit in her chest when she looked at Catra. She felt so excited, she barely knew if she could sleep.

Adora decided she would ask for Catra's hand in two mornings. She had a plan—she'd pull Catra out to look at the sunrise with her, just like they've done countless of times, and she'd ask her then. It wasn't the ornate thing that Adora originally had in mind but she hoped Catra would see it was heartfelt and she didn't want to wait any longer. She'd ask the very next morning if she didn't have to go hunting for their rings before she asked.

Adora was careful as she laid down, not wanting to wake Catra. She wrapped her arms around her, reveling in the way Catra sighed in her sleep, her purr coming to a stop before rumbling louder than before. Adora buried her nose in the crook of Catra's neck, hiding her smile there. She let her fingers run over Catra's hip and then meander to her waistline.

She knew Catra's body almost better than her own. She let her fingers stop around the king's midsection and she noticed a bump there. At first, Adora thought she imagined it but as she ran her hand over it, it became unmistakable. Catra was with child.

The first emotion she felt was an overwhelming, reckless joy that she'd never experienced before. She'd longed for a child with Catra since before they married, the idea of a little prince to love and expand their family had always warmed her.

But then a thought occurs to her. "Why wouldn't she say anything?" Adora couldn't help but whisper to herself.

If Adora fell pregnant, the first thing she'd do would be tell Catra. She'd share the news with the person she loved most. The only other person who would understand.

Unless, Adora wouldn't understand. Maybe Catra didn't want the baby. Adora thought she and Catra were on the same page—they'd talked about children at length in their marriage. But it had been a long time since then. With the war and her disappearance, children were the last thing on their mind. Maybe Catra's feelings had changed.

Adora's heart felt heavy at the thought. But Adora would stand by Catra for anything, including this. She didn't know why Catra hadn't spoke to her but one things for certain. She'd have to wait until the morning to get the answers she sought. Adora nuzzled Catra closer, hoping against hope that whatever they faced they could resolve together.

It was the perfect morning in many ways. Catra could feel Adora pressed to her back, her arms around her as she ran her fingers softly over Catra's ears. She flicked one of them, letting Adora know that she was awake.

She felt a huff of breath on her neck before Adora placed a soft kiss there. "Good morning, my king."

Catra turned around so that she was facing Adora. She looked gorgeous laying there, the sun coming in and hitting her, highlighting the definition of her arms and her back. Her hair isn't cropped quiet as short as it used to be, a few locks falling in her eyes. "Morning, princess." As she rubbed the sleep out of her eyes, she remembered Adora wasn't there the night before. "I didn't know you were coming back so soon."

"I couldn't possibly stay away." Adora leaned forward and slowly kissed her, tender and soft. It reminded her of late nights and early morning, of years of loving Adora.

"Well, far be it for me to turn the mighty She-ra from my bed." She wrapped her arms around Adora, breathing her in. She expected the blonde to laugh, not to tense beneath Catra's touch.

When she looked up Adora was worrying her lip, concern overlayed on her features. "You know that I would support you in all things?" Adora blurted out abruptly, her eyes searching Catra's gaze. "You're what's most important to me, Catra. I only wish to be here for you."

She ran a hand over Adora's cheek. "I know."

"And you can tell me anything." Adora searched her gaze, and then slowly her eyes drop down to Catra's torso. She reached her hand out softly touching the bump she thought she'd mostly hidden. "Anything, Catra."

She sucked in a sharp breath. Between Adora's careful words and reverent touch, Catra had no doubt that Adora knew. "I'm pregnant. We're having a baby." She rushed out, the words that had been stuck in her throat finally freed. "I've been wanting to tell you."

She expected Adora to be angry at her for not telling her immediately. Instead, her eyes are filled with tears, her smile wide as she presses her hand more firmly against the bump. "Our baby." She said with wonder before she pressed her forehead against Catra's. "How long have you suspected?" The question holds no judgment.

"A few weeks. I've been nauseous and my breasts have been sensitive. And the bump." She leaned forward, nestling herself against Adora's chest. It felt like a physical weight lifted off of her, to have Adora know the truth.

Adora let out a deep sigh. "I'm sorry if I did anything to make you think you couldn't tell me." She offered haltingly.

"I didn't—you haven't done anything wrong." Catra bit her lip, unsure of what more she can say without bringing up the parts of her pregnancy that worried her so.

"I must have. I've been away too much in recent times. The end of the war is no excuse." Adora cupped her jaw tenderly. "I fought that war so we could be together. It's time we do that." Adora leaned in close, her hand reaching down to interlace with Catra's claws. "Catra. Do you want to elope?" She whispered hopefully.

The word rebounded in Catra's mind, her tail whipping behind her. "Elope?" he echoed.

Adora nodded surely. "Tomorrow. Today, even." Her eyes brightened. "I'm sure Tao would marry us again on short notice."

She pulled back some, studying the blonde's face. "Adora, are you sure?"

Her blue eyes lit up, She-ra's power peeking out from within her. "I've never been more sure of anything in my life." She took Catra's small hands in hers. "From the moment we captured Lord Hordak, I've been planning to propose." She explained softly. "I was waiting for the right moment, but to be perfectly honest..." She cupped Catra's cheek. "I think even if you weren't with child, I'd collapse into myself if I had to wait a year to put together a royal wedding."

Catra let out a surprised laugh. "Adora, you don't have to be this dramatic." It felt like whiplash, to go from wondering if Adora would ever propose to the blonde offering to marry her the very same day.

"It's not theatrics, Catra. I've been on the verge of proposing for months now and I'm tired of waiting. I actually had plans to propose tomorrow morning." She admitted.

Catra could hardly believe it. "Tomorrow morning?"

"Yes. I was hoping to find where our rings are before I did." Her cheeks blushed red. "I guess, I might have bungled that part."

"You haven't." Catra breathed out.

Adora looked encouraged. "If you'll take me now, I'll swear under every law and treaty that you and I belong to each other." She leaned forward, pressing their foreheads together. "I don't care about the consequences as long as we are where we are meant to be. Together."

"And the kit?" She breathed out.

"You, me, and the little prince." Adora promised. "I don't need anything else."

It was everything Catra needed too but something stopped her. "I don't want you to feel pressured."

Adora furrowed her brow. "Do you feel that I don't wish to marry you?"

"No, Adora. I know you do." She sighed. "But you were waiting for reasons. And I don't want you to feel like we have to move faster than you were ready to just because we fear that our child won't be the legitimate heir if the throne if we wait."

Adora's face froze for a moment in surprise. "I...I hadn't thought of that at all." She confessed. "And to be honest, I'd love you and the kit more than anything regardless of whether they were heir or not."

She swallowed thickly. "I know."

Adora's gaze narrowed as she drew closer, forcing Catra to move onto her back. "And I've just told you I was planning on proposing tomorrow."

"You did say that." She admitted grudgingly.

The blonde was not proposed over her. "Then?" Adora pressed, her hand rubbing along Catra's bump. "Let me love you, woman." Her voice carried a laugh with a hint of nervousness. "Please, let me." She whispered, more awed now.

She fully melted into her embrace nodding feverishly. "Okay. Yes."

"Yes?" Adora's relief clung to the syllable.

"Yes." Catra could feel tears welling behind her eyes, spilling despite her best efforts to blink them away.

Adora brushed away her tears smiling like it would split her face open. Suddenly, Catra was corralled in Adora's arms but they were much bigger. When she looked up at the blonde she had a sheepish grin, She-ra's face staring back at her.

"A little emotional?" Catra guessed, laying comfortably on the blonde's chest.

Her chuckle was deeper as She-ra, magic overlaying her voice. "Very. I've been thinking about this for so long."

"Me too."

"I'm sorry it took this long." Adora whispered into her skin. "I'd wanted to ask but I just—when you asked me to marry you, it's one of the best memories I have. I wanted it to be special. Between everything happening, I didn't really know how to ask the way you deserved."

"It is memorable. I didn't need fanfare, Adora. I just wanted you to ask." Catra lifted her hand up to her torso, Adora's hand now big enough to cover almost the whole area. "I wanted you to *want*." She wanted Adora to want her, to want this baby, this life in Halfmoon. She had the ability to do anything she wanted now as the Princess of Power but Catra hoped this would still be enough.

"I always want, Catra. You and the kit." She rubbed her hand in soothing circles, slowly shrinking until she was back to her normal size. "Catra." She breathed out, wonder in full display. "We get to be parents."

"We do." She agreed, placing a soft kiss on Adora's cheek. This was what she always day dreamed about whenever she thought of having children with Adora—laying together and sharing in it. "You're going to be such a nervous wreck."

"Absolutely." Adora agreed gleefully. "Im going to need to prepare. Do you think it's too soon to start carving a crib? I need to make a list of everything we need." She mumbled absentmindedly.

"It'll be fine. I'm mostly worried about having your coronation before I'm as big as one of the village cottages."

Adora's grin couldn't be wider. "You'll be rounded with my child and absolutely beautiful."

"You can't know that." She protested, feeling her cheeks redden.

Adora let out a scoff, dropping a soft kiss on Catra's forehead. "Catra, you've never been anything but gorgeous a day in your life."

"You're biased." She accused.

"I'm correct." Adora was devious, running her hand over the soft fur at the base of her ear that never failed to make her rumble.

Still, Catra wouldn't let her win that easy. "Ridiculous." She managed, even as her purr started up.

"Brat." Adora responded playfully. She slowly stopped scratching behind Catra's ear, much to her disappointment. "So, want to get married today or tomorrow?"

"You were serious?" She knew the proposal was genuine, but she figured the idea of getting married that same day was an exaggeration on Adora's part.

Apparently not. "Yes, Catra. Let's get married." Her voice was practically a whine as she leaned down and captured her lips in a kiss. "Please?" She all but begged.

Catra had no will to resist Adora when she asked for things, and truly, she had no reason to want to resist. "Let's see what Tao has to do today."

It was a whirlwind. Even when it was just them, no fanfare, it took mobilizing a number of people to get ready for their nuptials. Adora was bouncing on her feet, waiting for Catra with Tao standing beside her. She smoothed out her military garb, the sharp vest snug on her frame. She finally had the Halfmoon uniform commissioned after Catra gave in and let her be knighted as She-ra.

"She won't be here for another few minutes, you know." Tao's voice was full of humor as he watched the blonde make her best impression of a stone being skipped on a lake.

"I know." It didn't stop Adora from keeping her eyes trained on the door. SHe didn't want to miss a moment of this.

"I'm glad you two finally sorted yourselves." If there was anyone who had always been in their corner, it had been Tao. So much so that he had officiated their first wedding.

"I am too."

"And the little one will be a welcome addition to the monarchy."

That made Adora glance back at the older magicat. "Did Catra tell you?"

"I had my suspicions for a while now." Tao smiled. "Catra was never one to be idle, but it seems like I can't find her awake these days. Shes missed at least two council meetings in favor of naps in the last month."

Now that Tao mentioned it, Catra had been sleeping more lately. A twinge of guilt sat in her gut as she realized there were obvious signs of her pregnancy she'd missed by being away. "She has been tired. I don't even know if she's seen a doctor." She worried aloud.

"You'll be able to sort it all out, your majesty." He placed a gentle hand on her shoulder. "Focus on the present right now."

Adora took a big breath. "You're right. It's almost time." Every minute felt like it was dragging, making fun of Adora and her excitement.

Finally, the door swung open, revealing Adam. Once he moved further in, Adora's eyes land on who she most wished to see. Catra is holding Adam's arm, looking ethereal in a blood red dress, the Halfmoon coat of arms embroidered onto her white cape. Its then that Adora realizes it's the cape she wore when they were first married.

"Wow." She whispered to herself.

The walk was only a few dozen feet but it might as well have been a life time that Adora was caught in Catra's stare. She'd privately wondered if this would feel the same as the first time they married, but she thought it might be better. They'd been through momentous adversity, things she never would have imagined when she first pledged her life to Catra. With that full knowledge, she was more than ready to pledge herself again.

Tao cleared his throat and that was how Adora realized Catra had made it to her. She blinked, holding out her hand so that Catra would take it, stepping up and across from her.

"I've never married the same couple twice." Tao started, his eyes darting between them with a wryly smile. "But I think this is for very good reason. Adora, Catra. We don't have to perform any of the Halfmoon rituals we had during your first wedding. However, I propose you two speak from the heart before you are joined again."

"Sentimental old man." Catra said as she surreptitiously dried a tear.

"And proud of it." He boasted, another rare smile making its way onto his face. "For giving me sass, you can go first."

The few people in the room burst into laughs before quieting down. Catra held her gaze, eyes shining with emotion.

"Adora, when I thought you died...it felt like a part of me went with you." Catra started, voice wobbling. Adora could immediately feel her throat close with tears too. "But even when all hope felt lost, I didn't think you'd really left me. I don't know if it was intuition or foolishness but I held on." She took a shuddering breath and Adora squeezed her hands in reassurance. "I'll never give up on you, Adora. I love you way too much for that. In my heart, you never stopped being my wife. I want to spending my life with you." She then shrugged and smiled, like she didn't say something so heartfelt it ripped through Adora's own heart and left it in tatters.

"Catra." Adora's voice was thick with tears but she pushed them back. She needed to do this right. "I've been in love with you since I was a young Bright Moon guard trying to catch a glimpse of the visiting Halfmoon prince." Catra laughed shaking her head but never letting go of Adora's hands. "I've made all kinds of promises and declarations to you. Some I've kept and some I haven't." She raised a hand to touch Catra's jaw. "But no matter what, I've always kept one promise—I've always loved you. I don't know how to stop and I won't ever bother to learn. I'll always love you." She repeated, unsure what else to say.

"Today, you unite in a partnership that's meant to be life long. Respect, love, and honor each other through it. Both as two women in love, as two regents shepherding Halfmoon, and... in any other role you might find yourself occupying." Adora's hand moved of their own volition to Catra's bump, to the place where their child slept soundly. "Your majesties, you are now joined in marriage. May this be the last time we have to perform the ceremony." Catra let out a water chuckle at that. "You may now celebrate with a kiss."

Adora leaned in and kisses Catra deeply, ignoring her brother's grunt in disgust. When they part Catra, grins widely. "We did it."

"We did." Adora's cheeks hurt from smiling so hard. There was something about knowing that no one and nothing could keep her from Catra, that they'd sealed their bond again in a way everyone will recognize. Adora's commitment never wavered but it felt good, regardless. "My wife." She mumbles under her breath.

Catra clearly caught that, her eyes darkening as she took Adora's hand interlacing her fingers. "Adam, I'll leave you and Tao to sort the paperwork?" She addressed him but her eyes were darting past him to the door.

"Yes. But first you're both getting a hug." He did just that, his arms wrapping around them and squeezing lightly. "I'm so happy for you. Congratulations. On *everything*."

The heavy was he said it made Adora tilt her head. "Do you know about the kit too?"

Catra winced but turned to face Adora. "He caught me throwing up in the hallway one night." She said evenly. "I meant to tell you but I got caught up in everything. He and Tao know, but no one else."

Adora's brows furrowed without her say-so, focusing on one thing. "You've been sick?" She asked worriedly.

Catra put a hand on Adora's shoulder, squeezing reassuringly. "Only a few times. I've mostly been okay."

"Hold on." Adora warned Catra before lifting her into Adora's arms, bridal style. She then looked at Adam. "Thank you, brother. For watching over her."

"Of course. Catra is my liege, my sister-in-law." His gaze softened. "And my friend."

"Only on the good days." The jab barely stung given how fondly Catra smiled at him.

"We will see you sometime tomorrow, I'm sure." Adora promised as she started to move out of the room. "Now, I think I'm going to spend time with my wife."

Adora carried Catra through the hallways, guards looked on in amusement. She was sure they suspected something was happening today but she trusted them to keep quiet. She only put Catra down once they were in her bedchambers.

Catra stayed close, wrapping her arms around Adora's shoulders. She pressed another full kiss to Adora's lips. "We did it." She said quietly again as if she couldn't believe it.

Adora understood. It felt like a rush—just this morning they were talking about it, about marriage and their child, and now they were married. Only one thought played in a loop in Adora's mind. "I cannot believe I get to have you, again." She'd built up asking Catra so much and even after failing to propose the way she'd planned, she still got to be her wife again.

"You've had me this whole time." Catra pointed out softly.

Adora shook her head. "Let me celebrate that you're my wife again." Her smile turned even brighter as her hand dropped to Catra's waist. "The mother of my child." She said dreamily. She only knew about their existence for a less than a day but she was already so in love with them.

Catra raised an eyebrow but she was unable to keep the smile off her face. "Sounds like that does something for you."

"It does. I feel so lucky." She started to worry Catra's neck with her teeth. "Do you think it'd be too gauche to go consumate our marriage now?" She whispered in the magicat's ear.

"You think anyone would expect any different?" Catra laughed freely. "Looks like you don't have anything to worry about." She affectionately rubbed her bump.

"Could never be too sure." Adora wrapped her arms around the slighter woman, watching as her tail wrapped around Adora's thigh. "Not sure if you're feeling up to it though. Apparently, you've been going through quite a bit without me."

Guilt flickered through her gaze. "I'm sorry. I wasn't trying to exclude you from anything."

Adora knew that if she'd been around for Catra to talk to, Catra would have ultimately found the courage to confide in her. They'd been through too much and knew each other too well for Adora to doubt it. At times, she thought, she knew Catra best and had more faith in her than the magicat did in herself. "I know. I think we were both stuck in our heads, hmm?"

Adora felt some sadness at not knowing but she'd been traveling a lot and clearly not proposing had taken a toll on Catra. She couldn't really blame her wife for trying to find the right moment when she struggled with a similar thing herself.

Catra smiled at her gratefully. "Yes. But now, it'll be us. A family."

Adora leaned in for another kiss, reveling in the way Catra's fang caught the edge of her lips. "Yes. I canceled all my travel plans for the month. After my coronation, we will sort through requests that come for She-ra the same we would any diplomatic request. Together."

Catra raised an eyebrow. "You don't think that will cause disharmony?"

Adora shrugged. "It might. But I'll be the Queen of Halfmoon again. I'm needed here and now that She-ra has done her part ending the war, they can be angry if they wish. I met my duty to Etheria." Adora raised Catra's hand to place a kiss on her palm. "Now, I only have my lifelong duties to attend to."

"Really? It'll all change overnight?" She asked with an incredulous eyebrow.

"Probably not." Adora freely admitted. "But you'll be there to make sure I check myself." She added with a coy grin.

She grunted when Catra pushed Adora onto the bed, toppling her over at the sudden gesture. The king smirked down at her before hiking up her dress and pressing herself into Adora's lap.

"I think that's enough politics for one wedding day." She said primly, even as she ground into Adora's lap. Her hands flew up to Catra's waist, anchoring her there. Adora could feel her mouth run dry and her gut tug low. She could see Catra's tail snapping behind her in impatience. "You said something about marital duties?" Catra leered.

"I said lifelong duties and"—Adora let out a sharp breath as Catra kissed along her neck—"consumation." She breathed out.

"Consumation, that's the one." Catra murmured against her neck before dropping a scent mark there. "You ready, princess?" It was practically a taunt, an invitation for Adora to rise to the occasion.

Adora's hand was halfway under the skirt of Catra's dress. She was more than happy to oblige her king, especially in this. "Of course."

Catra pushed the council meeting to two in the afternoon, and even still, she and Adora barely made it out of bed in time for the

meeting. It didn't help that Adora had insisted they eat first, stating that it wasn't good for the kit for Catra to go without food for so long.

She'd held back a snark that Adora hadn't been worried about that the night before, lest the blonde get the idea that her advances were anything but welcome. Catra felt lighter than she had in years, so much slotting into place in a way that felt almost instantaneous.

Adora nudged her and Catra realized that everyone was in place, ready to start. Her councilmembers looked at her and Adora on the dias, not the most common sight. Given that Adora was not the Queen of Halfmoon, she usually was excused from meetings unless she had a report to give as She-ra.

"This is a little different than our usual meetings." Catra acknowledged first, tossing a side-long glance Adora's way. "I wanted to inform the council that yesterday, I was married. We will have to prepare for the coronation of princess Adora as Queen of Halfmoon." She smiles widely. "Again."

"Yes!" Teela burst out before covering her mouth. "I'm sorry for speaking out of turn, your majesties. It's quiet the welcome surprise."

Adora laughed, letting her arm wrap around Catra's waist in an open display of affection she would have held back before. "We are both very excited about our renewed union. And I am thrilled to take my place again as Halfmoon's Queen. Please, let me know what I can do to assist in the preparations."

Catra couldn't help but stare at Adora as she spoke serenely. It was a far cry from the nervous Bright Moon guard she was the first time they announced their engagement to the Halfmoon council.

"We have another announcement but this one must stay private for a while longer." Catra bit her lip before looking up at Adora.

"Adora and I suspect I am with child. Halfmoon will finally have its heir." To her surprise, the council broke out in applause, losing all sense of decorum. Even Tao, usually the most stern in these meetings, let out a loud whoop. "All in all, a happy day we think. That being said, I will defer the dias to Tao so you all can handle business without me. Tao, you can report anything of note. Adora and I will be taking a few days to ourselves."

With that, she tugged on Adora's arm, making her way out as her council got louder, no doubt discussing the future birth of the prince and Adora's coronation.

"We're taking a few days to ourselves?" Adora echoed the question with a raised eyebrow.

"Yes. You've canceled your travel plans and I'm going to take advantage." She blustered. "Besides, I really do have to see a doctor and soon we will be in the middle of planning a coronation. Soon, there will be too much to do and I want to have a moment with you." She'd missed Adora and as thrilled as she was to have married her again, she wanted to spend time doing ordinary things with her too.

Adora's eyes softened and she leaned forward, pressing her forehead to Catra's. "You make many excellent points, my king."

"I know. We also have to prepare for Glimmer storming Halfmoon demanding to know why we didn't invite her." She added.

Adora snorted. "I'll just reminded her that she tried to marry you and I think she'll be sufficiently cowed."

Catra laughed. "You can't hold that against her forever."

"Yes, I can. You've never seen me try to marry Bow." Adora huffed but she couldn't keep the smile off her face.

"You're a lesbian, Adora."

"Minor details, really." She tried to keep the banter but Adora let out a laugh. "Okay, no. I really can't marry Bow."

"Good thing the four of us are married now. To the right people." Catra added.

"Yes. Let's go back to our room so I can make sure you feel vindicated in your decision-making." Adora was cocky, looking like the knight she was through and through as she leaned forward, towering over Catra. Still, Catra caught a detail that distracts her from her wive's seduction.

"Our room now." She leaned forward and pressed a lingering kiss on Adora's lips. "No more sneaking."

"No more sneaking, dearest." Adora agreed, wrapping her arms around Catra again. Her hand continued its path, rubbing against Catra's bump. She wasn't sure if Adora even knew she was doing it.

Catra nuzzled into Adora's neck and held her fiercely. She resolved that this was the one thing no one could take from her. She'd strip her titles and riches before she ever let anything come between her and her family. Thankfully, with peace in Etheria, all she had to worry about now was living out the dreams she'd always kept close to her heart.

End Notes

Welp, I always have a great time when I revisit this version of Catradora. As my first multichapter work, Medieval AU holds a special place in my heart. I hope you enjoyed the addition.

Let me know your thoughts! I'm particularly interested to know what people who read the main fic and this think versus folks who read it as a stand-alone one-shot.

Kudos and comments make me happy. You can find me on Twitter and Tumblr.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!